



For the Acne Expert: Medications and Drugs That Can Affect Acne

This document is not meant to be given to your client. Always advise your client to work with their doctor about any questions about current medications.

Below are some medications and drugs that can affect acne. If your client is using any of these, you can speak to them about the details below.

MEDICATION	ROUTE	USES/DESCRIPTION
Antibiotics	Oral	Prescribed to treat acne. Clients can continue using this drug while using FR treatments and products. Probiotics can be beneficial to restore gut flora after taking antibiotics. Examples: tetracycline, minocycline, doxycycline, erythromycin, clindamycin,
Antibiotics	Topical	Must wait 2 weeks after discontinuing use before clients can begin actives or have a treatment. Examples: clindamycin (Cleocin-T), erythromycin (Erygel), dapsone (Aczone)
Retinoids	Topical	Vitamin A derivatives. Must wait 2 weeks after discontinuing use before clients can begin actives or have a treatment. Examples: Retin-A (tretinoin), Avita (tretinoin), Tazorac (tazarotene), Differin (adapalene)
Thyroid medications	Oral	Contains high levels of iodides which can exacerbate acne. May take longer to see improvement in skin. Examples: Levothyroxine (Levothroid, Synthroid, Tirosint, Unithroid)
Azelaic Acid	Topical	For treatment of rosacea. If using a prescription version, the client must wait 2 weeks after discontinuing use before clients can begin actives or have a treatment. Examples: Finacea, Azelex
Capaxone	Oral	Glatiramer Acetate. For treatment of Multiple Sclerosis (MS). Acne is a known side effect.

These materials and content are for informational purposes only to assist trained skin care professionals in developing individualized skincare programs for their clients. The materials and their contents are not to be reproduced or distributed without Face Reality's express written consent.



MEDICATION	ROUTE	USES/DESCRIPTION
Spironolactone	Oral	A diuretic used to treat high blood pressure and acne. Clients can continue using this drug while using FR treatments and products. Examples: Aldactone, CaroSpir
Isotretinoin	Oral	Vitamin A derivative. Must wait a minimum of 1 month after discontinuing use before clients can begin actives or have a treatment. Some clients' skin will still be too dry to be treated for a longer period of time. Examples: Accutane (not available in the US), Zenatane, Absorica, Myorisan, Claravis
Corticosteroids	Oral & Topical	Treats asthma, inflammatory bowel disease, and skin rashes. Can exacerbate acne. Examples: Prednisone, cortisone, hydrocortisone
Steroid Hormones	Steroid Hormones	Primary sex hormones that may exacerbate acne. Examples: testosterone, progesterone
Fertility Drugs	Injectable	Can exacerbate acne. Examples: Pregnyl, Chorionic Gonadotropin, Ovidrel, Novarel
Danazol	Oral	Treats endometriosis and fibrocystic breast disease and has androgenic properties which can exacerbate acne. Example: Danocrine
Cyclosporin	Oral	Drug to reduce transplant rejection. May take longer to see improvement in skin. Examples: Sandiummne, Neoral, Gengraf
Lithium	Oral	Treats bipolar disorder. Likely to exacerbate acne and it is difficult to see improvement when taking this drug. Examples: Eskalith, Lithobid
Isoniazid (INH)	Oral	Treats Tuberculosis and is likely to exacerbate acne. Examples: Hydra, Hyzyd, Isovit

These materials and content are for informational purposes only to assist trained skin care professionals in developing individualized skincare programs for their clients. The materials and their contents are not to be reproduced or distributed without Face Reality's express written consent.



MEDICATION	ROUTE	USES/DESCRIPTION
Azathioprine	Oral	Immunosuppressant for organ transplant and Multiple Sclerosis (MS). Suppresses the body's ability to fight bacteria. Examples: Imuran, Azasan
Disulfiram	Oral	For enforced sobriety of alcoholism. Can exacerbate acne. Example: Antabuse
Phenytoin	Oral	Anticonvulsant, seizure medication. Example: Dilantin
Carbamazepine	Oral	Treats seizures, nerve pain, and bipolar disorder. Can exacerbate acne. Example: Tegretol

These materials and content are for informational purposes only to assist trained skin care professionals in developing individualized skincare programs for their clients. The materials and their contents are not to be reproduced or distributed without Face Reality's express written consent.